

To Whom It May Concern,

March 4th, 2026

My name is Ryan-Nguyen Ngo, and I'm writing to raise concerns about the management and working conditions at Joe's Crab Shack in Sacramento, CA — especially under **General Manager Alvin Prakash** and how the staff have been treated during my time there.

I started working there in January 2025. Back then, we had six managers and a strong team dynamic. Things shifted fast once one manager was let go for "overcompensation," and another followed shortly after. With fewer managers around, morale started dipping. The hits kept coming — employees were fired for unclear reasons, and others left for better opportunities. What was left behind was a crew scrambling to cover shifts, facing burnout, and dealing with mounting pressure, especially during the holidays.

I didn't just bus tables. I helped run food, seat customers, present dishes, and close the restaurant — all while being paid as a busser. I wasn't trained in those roles. I just paid attention, asked questions, and stepped in because people needed help. Not once did Prakash acknowledge any of that — not for me, and not for the others putting in that kind of effort.

The moment that pushed me to speak up happened on **Saturday, February 28th, 2026**. A walk-in party of about 55 people arrived right before closing. Two bussers were on — one still in training, the other a coworker of mine — and they were left to manage the chaos. Some staff stayed behind to help clean, others didn't. The next day, **Sunday, March 1st around 4:45 p.m.**, a manager (who actually works closely with bussers and recognizes our efforts) pulled us into the office for a meeting. But instead of showing up, Prakash phoned in, criticized us, and made it clear that "this won't be tolerated again." No accountability. No acknowledgment of what we just dealt with. Just criticism.

At that point, I had had enough. On **March 2nd**, I left the restaurant intentionally messy. It wasn't out of laziness — it was to send a message. If the GM doesn't recognize our work, then he should finally see what things look like without it. It wasn't my proudest move, but it was the only way I felt I could be heard. I made sure coworkers knew that if I didn't show up to work Friday, March 6th, it was because I had been silenced.

This isn't just about me. It's about the constant instability. People come and go too often, and it's hard not to notice. While these numbers may not be exact and are based on what I personally observed throughout the chaos of the year, they still reflect

far more than what Prakash has ever acknowledged. The amount of turnover and instability I witnessed says enough:

- **Bussers:** 4 left for unknown reasons, 2 left for better opportunities, 1 switched positions due to physical demand, 2 (including myself) left for the Marines.
- **Runners:** 1 promoted but had his hours cut so badly he left, 2 left for unknown reasons; current staff now get 1–2 shifts per week.
- **Servers:** 3 fired, 3 left for unknown reasons.
- **Bar:** 3 left, 1 fired — reasons unclear.
- **Host:** 3 quit, 1 fired.
- **Kitchen (Chefs):** 2 left with no known reason.
- **Dishwasher:** 1 fired for multiple no-call/no-shows. But even before that, he was handling more than dishwashing — often doing prep and inventory too, without any pay raise or role change. Since then, current dishwashers or even chefs are expected to cover those extra duties too.

This isn't to say all managers are at fault. The closers who stepped up and tried to help deserve recognition. Some worked with us — not above us. But Prakash rarely stayed for closing, didn't train new managers properly, and spent more time criticizing from a distance than actually seeing what we go through firsthand. That's not what leadership should look like.

I've served as a leader before — as a Student Lead at UC Berkeley, a club treasurer, and now soon to be a United States Marine. I've seen what strong leadership is, and what it's not. Real leaders communicate, support, and stand alongside their team. That didn't happen here.

This isn't an act of retaliation. It's a message that something needs to change. I may be on my way out, but my coworkers are still there, doing everything they can to keep things running — and they deserve better.

Thank you for taking the time to read this.

Sincerely,

Ryan-Nguyen D. Ngo

Former Busser, Joe's Crab Shack – Sacramento, CA